

### 8.2.8 Other staff and officials

The following staff and officials are entitled to import personal and household effects without payment of duties within twelve months of first installation:

- The administrative and technical staff of an embassy and their families provided that they are not Irish nationals or are non-permanent residents.
- Non-diplomatic Consular employees, other than consular employees of the USA, to whom this time limit does not apply.
- Officials of the UN as notified to the Department of Foreign Affairs.
- Officials of the Specialised Agencies of the UN as notified.
- Members of the European Commission, Judges, the Advocate General, the Registrar and the Assistant Rapporteurs of the European Court of Justice and other officials and servants of the Communities named in the Protocol on the Privileges and Immunities of the European Union.
- Officials of the Institutions mentioned at the first paragraph of this section.

## 8.3 Returned Goods

### 8.3.1 Introduction

Relief is provided from Customs duties on Union goods being re-imported for free circulation (Articles 203 – 207 UCC) Articles 158-160 DA and Articles 253-256 IA).

To qualify for relief, the goods must be re-imported within three years from the date of export, but this may be exceeded in special circumstances. Goods qualify for relief even where they represent a portion of the goods exported and the provision also applies where the goods consist of spare parts and accessories belonging to the product exported.

In the case of goods originally imported at a favourable rate of Customs Duty because of their use e.g. end-use, the grant of the returned goods relief is subject to their being re-imported for the same purpose. Where the goods will not be used for the same purpose, the duty normally chargeable is to be reduced by the favourable amount, if any, originally charged. However, where the favourable amount originally charged exceeds the amount normally chargeable at the time the goods are being re-imported and released for free circulation no refund is to be allowed.

### 8.3.2 Normal rule - goods must not have received treatment abroad

Further information on [the rules for duty relief on returned goods](#) is available on the Revenue website. Normally, goods are not eligible for re-admission under the returned goods relief unless re-imported in the same state as they were exported. There are some exceptions to this outlined below.